
MINDFULNESS SKILLS

Introduction to Handouts and Worksheets

Mindfulness is the act of consciously focusing the mind in the present moment, without judgment and without attachment to the moment. A person who is mindful is aware in and of the present moment. Mindfulness is the opposite of being on “automatic pilot,” or being lost in habit. Mindfulness has to do with the quality of awareness that a person brings to everyday living. It’s a way of living awake, with eyes wide open. As a set of skills, mindfulness practice is the intentional process of observing, describing, and participating in reality nonjudgmentally, in the moment, and with effectiveness (i.e., using skillful means). We can contrast mindfulness with rigidly clinging to the present moment, as if we could keep a present moment from changing if we cling hard enough. When we are mindful, we are open to the fluidity of each moment as it arises and falls away.

Goals and Definitions

- **Mindfulness Handout 1: Goals of Mindfulness Practice.** The goals of practicing mindfulness skills, for most people, are to reduce suffering, increase happiness, and increase control of the mind. For some, a goal of mindfulness is to experience reality *as it is*. Mindfulness skills require practice, practice, practice.
- **Mindfulness Handout 2: Mindfulness Definitions.** This handout offers basic definitions of mindfulness, mindfulness skills, and mindfulness practice.
- **Mindfulness Worksheet 1: Pros and Cons of Practicing Mindfulness.** This worksheet is designed to help you decide whether you have anything to gain from practicing mindfulness.

Core Mindfulness Skills

The handouts and worksheets for **Core Mindfulness Skills** cover seven skills in three sets: Wise Mind; the “what” skills of observing, describing, and participating; and the “how” skills of practicing nonjudgmentally, one-mindfully, and effectively.

- **Mindfulness Worksheets 2, 2a, 2b, and 2c: Mindfulness Core Skills Practice** offer four variations for recording practice of all seven core mindfulness skills. They can be useful for recording practice after you have learned all of the core skills. **Mindfulness Worksheet 2c: Mindfulness Core Skills Calendar** offers a calendar format for recording practice of all these skills.

WISE MIND

- **Mindfulness Handout 3: Wise Mind: States of Mind.** Wise Mind is the inner wisdom that each one of us has. When we access our inner wisdom, we say we are in Wise Mind. When we enter the state of Wise Mind, we integrate opposites—including our reasonable and emotional states of mind—and we are open to experiencing reality as it is.

- You can record your practice efforts on **Mindfulness Worksheet 3: Wise Mind Practice.** (**Mindfulness Handout 3a: Ideas for Practicing Wise Mind** offers practice ideas.) Worksheet 3 asks you to rate how effective your practice was in accessing your own Wise Mind. Note that the rating is not about whether the practice calmed you or made you feel better.

MINDFULNESS “WHAT” SKILLS

- **Mindfulness Handout 4: Taking Hold of Your Mind: “What” Skills.** “What” skills are what you do when practicing mindfulness—observe, describe, or participate. Do only one of these activities at a time. To observe is to pay attention on purpose to the present moment. To describe is to put into words what you have observed. To participate is to enter into an activity fully and wholly, becoming one with whatever you are doing.

- **Mindfulness Handout 4a: Ideas for Practicing Observing, Mindfulness Handout 4b: Ideas for Practicing Describing, and Mindfulness Handout 4c: Ideas for Practicing Participating** offer ideas for how to practice each of the mindfulness “what” skills. If you are just learning these skills, your skills trainer is likely to assign a specific exercise or two after you first practice each skill in a session.

- **Mindfulness Worksheets 4, 4a, and 4b** offer three different formats for recording practice of mindfulness “what” skills. **Worksheet 4** provides space for practice of the “what” skills only twice between sessions. **Worksheet 4a** gives space for multiple practices for each “what” skill in a checklist format. **Worksheet 4b** is aimed at those who like to write describing their practice.

MINDFULNESS “HOW” SKILLS

- **Mindfulness Handout 5: Taking Hold of Your Mind: “How” Skills.** The “how” skills are how you observe, describe, or participate—nonjudgmentally, one-mindfully, and effectively. Although the “what” skills should only be done one at a time, the “how” skills can be done together.

- **Mindfulness Handout 5a: Ideas for Practicing Nonjudgmentalness, Mindfulness Handout 5b: Ideas for Practicing One-Mindfulness, and Mindfulness Handout 5c: Ideas for Practicing Effectiveness** offer ideas for how to practice each of the mindfulness “how” skills. If you are just learning these skills, your skills trainer is likely to assign a specific exercise or two after you practice each one in a session.

- **Mindfulness Worksheet 5: Mindfulness “How” Skills: Nonjudgmentalness, One-Mindfulness, Effectiveness** provides space for recording only two practices of a “how” skill for the week. **Mindfulness Worksheet 5a: Nonjudgmentalness, One-Mindfulness, Effectiveness Checklist** offers a checklist format for recording “how” skills practice, and **Mindfulness Worksheet 5b: Nonjudgmentalness, One-Mindfulness, Effectiveness Calendar** offers a calendar format for this purpose. **Mindfulness Worksheet 5c: Nonjudgmentalness Calendar** is an advanced worksheet for the single skill of nonjudgmentalness.

Other Perspectives on Mindfulness Skills

There are three sets of handouts and worksheets for **mindfulness skills** that give a different perspective on mindfulness. These are **Mindfulness Practice: A Spiritual Perspective**; **Skillful Means: Balancing Doing Mind and Being Mind**; and **Wise Mind: Walking the Middle Path**. Some DBT skills training programs may include one or more of these sets of skills.

- **Mindfulness Handout 6: Overview: Other Perspectives on Mindfulness.** This handout briefly previews the three supplementary mindfulness skills.

MINDFULNESS PRACTICE: A SPIRITUAL PERSPECTIVE

- **Mindfulness Handout 7: Goals of Mindfulness Practice: A Spiritual Perspective.** Mindfulness can be practiced for psychological reasons or spiritual reasons. A spiritual perspective on mindfulness is included for those for whom spirituality is an important part of their life. Mindfulness practice is very old, arising initially from spiritual practices across many cultures, and it has a modern-day presence in many contemplative prayer and meditation practices.

- **Mindfulness Handout 7a: Wise Mind from a Spiritual Perspective.** This handout outlines different types of spiritual practices and includes some of the many terms used to reference the transcendent. Many spiritual and religious practices share elements in common with mindfulness practices, including silence, quieting the mind, attentiveness, inwardness, and receptivity. These are characteristics of deep spiritual experiences.

- **Mindfulness Handout 8: Practicing Loving Kindness to Increase Love and Compassion.** Anger, hate, hostility, and ill will toward ourselves and toward others can be very painful. The practice of loving kindness is a form of meditation in which specific positive words and phrases are repeatedly recited, to cultivate compassion and loving feelings as an antidote to negativity. Loving kindness is an ancient spiritual meditation practice. In some ways it is similar to praying for the welfare of

ourselves and others. To record practice of loving kindness, use **Mindfulness Worksheet 6: Loving Kindness**, which provides space for describing two occasions of practicing loving kindness.

SKILLFUL MEANS: BALANCING DOING MIND AND BEING MIND

- **Mindfulness Handout 9: Skillful Means: Balancing Doing Mind and Being Mind.** “Skillful means” is a term in Zen that refers to any effective method that aids you to experience reality as it is—or, in DBT terms, to enter fully into Wise Mind. Doing mind and being mind are states of mind that, in their extreme forms, can get in the way of skillful means and of Wise Mind. Doing mind focuses on achieving goals; being mind focuses on experiencing. The polarity between them is similar to that between reasonable mind and emotion mind. In everyday life, wise living requires us to balance working to achieve goals (on the one hand), and at the very same time to let go of attachment to achieving goals (on the other hand).

- **Mindfulness Handout 9a: Ideas for Practicing Balancing Doing Mind and Being Mind.** This handout lists practice exercises. It is useful when you have already gone through mindfulness training several times.

- **Mindfulness Worksheet 7a: Mindfulness of Being and Doing Calendar, Mindfulness Worksheet 8: Mindfulness of Pleasant Events Calendar, and Mindfulness Worksheet 9: Mindfulness of Unpleasant Events Calendar** are all worksheets in calendar format that ask participants to record their mindfulness practice each day. The calendars focus on mindfulness during frazzled moments (Worksheet 7a), pleasant events (Worksheet 8), and unpleasant events (Worksheet 9).

WISE MIND: WALKING THE MIDDLE PATH

- **Mindfulness Handout 10: Walking the Middle Path: Finding the Synthesis between Opposites.** Wise Mind is the middle path between extremes. In Wise Mind, we replace “either–or” with “both–and” thinking in an effort to find a synthesis between oppositions. Ordinarily, when we are at an extreme on any continuum, we are in danger of distorting reality. This handout is useful if you have already gone through mindfulness training one or more times.

- **Mindfulness Worksheet 10: Walking the Middle Path to Wise Mind.** This worksheet lists several polarities that could be out of balance, and provides space for recording practice aimed at balancing them.

- **Mindfulness Worksheet 10a: Analyzing Yourself on the Middle Path.** Use this worksheet to think through whether you are out of balance on each of the polarities listed. “Out of balance” here means a living style that knocks you off your center, out of Wise Mind.

- **Mindfulness Worksheet 10b: Walking the Middle Path Calendar.** This worksheet offers opportunities for recording daily practice in a different format than in Worksheet 10. It can also be used in conjunction with Worksheet 10a.

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Mindfulness Handouts

Handouts for Goals and Definitions

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Goals of Mindfulness Practice

REDUCE SUFFERING AND INCREASE HAPPINESS

☐ Reduce pain, tension, and stress.

☐ Other: _____

INCREASE CONTROL OF YOUR MIND

☐ Stop letting your mind be in control of you.

☐ Other: _____

EXPERIENCE REALITY AS IT IS

☐ Live life with your eyes wide open.

☐ Experience the reality of your . . .

- connection to the universe.
- essential “goodness.”
- essential validity.

☐ Other: *-focusing and paying attention.* _____

-identifying your needs.

-recognizing when you're reaching sensory overload.

-increasing self-awareness.

-regulating emotions.

-allowing intrusive or judgmental thoughts to pass.

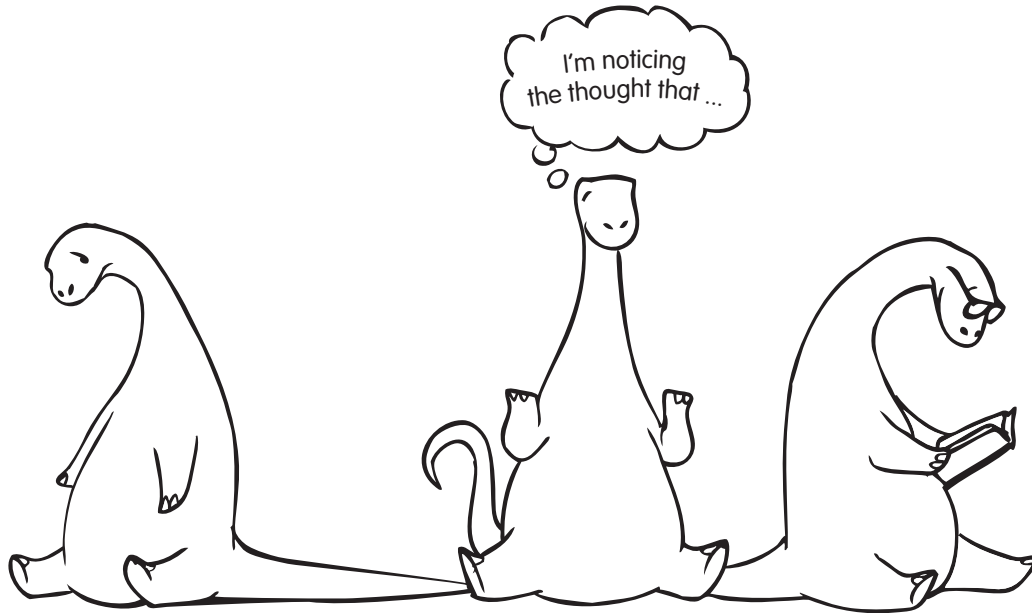
-making intentional choices and decisions.

-coping with rejection and criticism.

-practicing compassion.

Mindfulness: Taking Hold of Your Mind

Being in control of your mind rather than letting your mind be in control of you.



1. **FULL AWARENESS (Opened Mind):** Being aware of the present moment (e.g., thoughts, emotions, and physical sensations) without judgment and without trying to change it.
2. **ATTENTIONAL CONTROL (Focused Mind):** Staying focused on one thing at a time.

Mindfulness Definitions

WHAT IS MINDFULNESS?

- **Intentionally living with awareness in the present moment.**
(Waking up from automatic or rote behaviors to participate and be present to our own lives.)
- **Without judging or rejecting the moment.**
(Noticing consequences, discerning helpfulness and harmfulness—but letting go of evaluating, avoiding, suppressing, or blocking the present moment.)
- **Without attachment to the moment.**
(Attending to the experience of each new moment, rather than ignoring the present by clinging to the past or grabbing for the future.)

WHAT ARE MINDFULNESS SKILLS?

- Mindfulness skills are the specific behaviors to practice that, when put together, make up mindfulness.

WHAT IS MINDFULNESS PRACTICE?

- **Mindfulness and mindfulness skills** can be practiced at any time, anywhere, while doing anything. Intentionally paying attention to the moment, without judging it or holding on to it, is all that is needed.
- **Meditation** is practicing mindfulness and mindfulness skills while sitting, standing, or lying quietly for a predetermined period of time. When meditating, we *focus* the mind (for example, we *focus* on body sensations, emotions, thoughts, or our breath), or we *open* the mind (paying attention to whatever comes into our awareness). There are many forms of meditation that differ mostly by whether we are opening the mind or focusing the mind—and, if focusing, depending on what is the focus of our attention.
- **Contemplative prayer** (such as Christian centering prayer, the rosary, Jewish Shema, Islamic Sufi practice, or Hindu raja yoga) is a spiritual mindfulness practice.
- **Mindfulness movement** also has many forms. Examples include yoga, martial arts (such as Qigong, tai chi, aikido, and karate), and spiritual dancing. Hiking, horseback riding, and walking can also be ways to practice mindfulness.

Mindfulness: Why Bother?

Being mindful can . . .

- 1.** Give you more choices and more control over your behavior. It helps you slow down and notice emotions, thoughts, and urges (i.e., increases self-awareness), and helps you choose a behavior more thoughtfully, rather than act impulsively and make situations worse.
- 2.** Reduce your emotional suffering and increase your pleasure and sense of well-being.
- 3.** Help you make important decisions (and balance overly emotional or overly logical decisions).
- 4.** Help focus your attention (i.e., be in control of your mind rather than letting your mind be in control of you) and therefore make you more effective and productive.
- 5.** Increase compassion for self and others.
- 6.** Lessen your pain, tension, and stress, and in turn can even improve your health.

Practice, practice, practice

WHEN TO USE MINDFULNESS

When practicing mindfulness, here's some things to remember:

You don't have to try all these skills at once. Try practising one skill at a time.

Do not judge yourself: let any thoughts, emotions or sensations pass with compassion and an open mind.

It's okay if you find your attention drifting, try and guide yourself back or perhaps incorporate stimming into your mindfulness activity.

You don't need to close your eyes, you can just stare at a spot on the ground if that feels more natural/comfortable.

There's actually no right or wrong way to be mindful - it's important to figure out what works for you like focusing on an external object or selecting movement based activities.

MINDFULNESS SKILL

WHEN YOU MIGHT USE IT

OBSERVE USING YOUR SENSES



when you need to stop
thoughts from spinning
when you need to practice
being in the present

MINDFUL APPRECIATION



when you need a reminder
when you need to practice
being in the present

SELF-CHECK IN



when you need to figure
out your needs
when you're reaching a point
of distress or meltdown

Use the following skills and tools in the rest of this section to explore and practice mindfulness.

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Handouts for Core Mindfulness Skills

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Overview: Core Mindfulness Skills

WISE MIND: STATES OF MIND

“WHAT” SKILLS

(what you do when practicing mindfulness):

Observing, Describing, Participating

“HOW” SKILLS

(how you practice when practicing mindfulness):

Nonjudgmentally, One-Mindfully, Effectively

THE WISE MIND

In DBT, there are three states of mind. These are described as: the logical mind, the emotional mind and the wise mind. The goal of our wise mind is to take the best of both worlds from our logical mind and our emotional mind to define what our wise mind means to us as individuals. We all have our own unique wise mind.

Often, for whatever reason, we can get stuck in our logical mind or emotional mind and while there are strengths and benefits to both, there are also some difficulties that occur when we remain in either mind.

Logical Mind:

A state of mind that is based on facts, reason and logic. In the logical mind, emotions are not taken into consideration. When using your logical mind, you might be looking at things analytically.

Might be good for: planning, researching, making decisions, analysing, control, grounding, learning skills.

Emotional mind:

A state of mind during which your emotions influence your behaviour and thoughts. In the emotional mind, it can be hard to access the logical mind and think clearly. If you're in an emotional mind, you may act impulsively and intensely.

Might be good for: passion, motivation, creativity, empathy, adapting, relationships, communication.

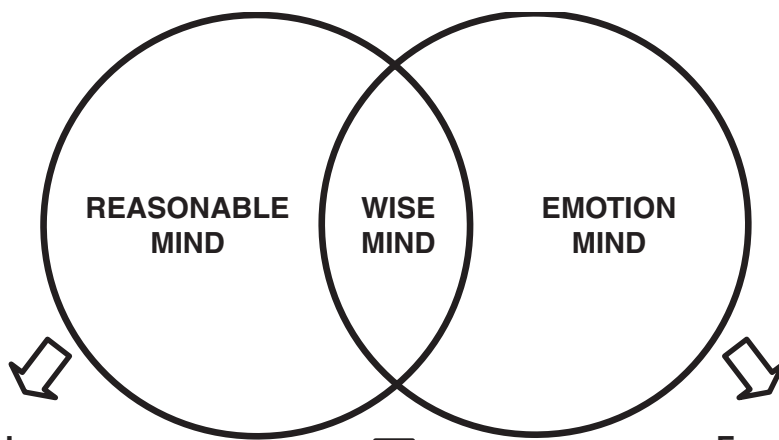
Wise mind:

A state of mind that's a combination of both the logical mind and emotional mind. We all have our own wise mind. In the wise mind, we respect and listen to both our emotional and logical mind.

Might be good for: communicating, making decisions, responding to events/situations, relationships, balance.



Wise Mind: States of Mind



Reasonable Mind Is:

Cool

Rational

Task-Focused

When in *reasonable mind*,
you are ruled by facts, reason,
logic, and pragmatics. Values
and feelings are not important.

Emotion Mind Is:

Hot

Mood-Dependent

Emotion-Focused

When in *emotion mind*,
you are ruled by your
moods, feelings, and urges
to do or say things. Facts,
reason, and logic are not
important.

Wise Mind Is:

The wisdom within
each person

Seeing the value of
both reason and
emotion

Bringing left brain and
right brain together

The middle path

Reasonable/logical Mind is “cool,” ruled by thinking, facts, and logic.

WHEN I AM IN LOGICAL MIND I TEND TO...

One example of Reasonable Mind this week was:

Emotional Mind is “hot,” ruled by your feelings and urges.

WHEN I AM IN EMOTION MIND I TEND TO ...

One example of Emotional Mind this week was:

Wise Mind includes both reason and emotion; it is the wisdom within and helps you avoid acting impulsively and helps you make important decisions. It helps us think more clearly in the presence of strong emotions.

WHEN I AM IN WISE MIND I TEND TO ...

One example of Wise Mind this week or month was:

ENGAGING THE WISE MIND

Below are some strategies you can use to practice engaging your wise mind.

MINDFULNESS

Notice your feelings, reactions, thoughts and any sensations happening in your body. Observe what is happening without any judgement or criticism.

CURIOSITY

Investigate what is happening with curiosity & compassion. Ask yourself: "What is this reaction trying to tell me?" and "What do I need right now?"

COMPASSION

Practice being compassionate, caring and understanding with yourself, just like you would a friend. You can even have a conversation with yourself out loud.

CONSIDER YOUR VALUES

One way to engage the wise mind is to remind yourself of your values. Does the action, behaviour or choice align with a value?

Ideas for Practicing Wise Mind

The mindfulness skills often require a *lot* of practice. As with any new skill, it is important to first practice when you don't need the skill. If you practice in easier situations, the skill will become automatic, and you will have the skill when you need it. Practice with your eyes closed and with your eyes open.

1. ☐ **Stone flake on the lake.** Imagine that you are by a clear blue lake on a beautiful sunny day. Then imagine that you are a small flake of stone, flat and light. Imagine that you have been tossed out onto the lake and are now gently, slowly, floating through the calm, clear blue water to the lake's smooth, sandy bottom.
 - Notice what you see, what you feel as you float down, perhaps in slow circles, floating toward the bottom. As you reach the bottom of the lake, settle your attention there within yourself.
 - Notice the serenity of the lake; become aware of the calmness and quiet deep within.
 - As you reach the center of your self, settle your attention there.

2. ☐ **Walking down the spiral stairs.** Imagine that within you is a spiral staircase, winding down to your very center. Starting at the top walk very slowly down the staircase, going deeper and deeper within yourself.
 - Notice the sensations. Rest by sitting on a step, or turn on lights on the way down if you wish. Do not force yourself further than you want to go. Notice the quiet. As you reach the center of your self, settle your attention there—perhaps in your gut or your abdomen.

3. ☐ **Breathing “Wise” in, “Mind” out.** Breathing in, say to yourself, “Wise”; breathing out, say “Mind.”
 - Focus your entire attention on the word “wise,” then, focus it again entirely on the word “mind.”
 - Continue until you sense that you have settled into Wise Mind.

4. ☐ **Asking Wise Mind a question.** Breathing in, silently ask Wise Mind a question.
 - Breathing out, listen for the answer.
 - Listen, but do not give yourself the answer. Do not tell yourself the answer; listen for it.
 - Continue asking on each in-breath for some time. If no answer comes, try again another time.

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MINDFULNESS HANDOUT 3A (p. 2 of 2)

5. ☐ **Asking is this Wise Mind?** Breathing in, ask yourself, “Is this (action, thought, plan, etc.) Wise Mind?”
- Breathing out, listen for the answer.
 - Listen, but do not give yourself the answer. Do not tell yourself the answer; listen for it.
 - Continue asking on each in-breath for some time. If no answer comes, try again another time.
6. ☐ **Attending to your breath coming in and out, let your attention settle into your center.**
- Breathing in completely, notice and follow the sensations of your breath coming in.
 - Let your attention settle into your center, at the bottom of your breath, at your solar plexus—*or*
 - Let your attention settle in the center of your forehead, your “third eye,” at the top of your breath.
 - Keeping your attention at your center, exhale, breathing normally, maintaining attention.
 - Settle into Wise Mind.
7. ☐ **Expanding awareness.** Breathing in, focus your awareness on your center.
- Breathing out, stay aware of your center, but expand awareness to the space you are in now.
 - Continue on in the moment.
8. ☐ **Dropping into the pauses between inhaling and exhaling.**
- Breathing in, notice the pause after inhaling (top of breath).
 - Breathing out, notice the pause after exhaling (bottom of breath).
 - At each pause, let yourself “fall into” the center space within the pause.

9. ☐ **Other Wise Mind practice ideas:** _____



Taking Hold of Your Mind: “What” Skills

OBSERVE

- ☐ **Notice your body sensations** (coming through your eyes, ears, nose, skin, and tongue).
- ☐ **Pay attention** on purpose, to the present moment.
- ☐ **Control your attention**, but not what you see. Push away nothing. Cling to nothing.
- ☐ **Practice wordless watching:** Watch thoughts come into your mind and let them slip right by like clouds in the sky. Notice each feeling, rising and falling, like waves in the ocean.
- ☐ **Observe both inside and outside yourself.**

DESCRIBE

- ☐ **Put words on the experience.** When a feeling or thought arises, or you do something, acknowledge it. For example, say in your mind, “Sadness has just enveloped me,” or “Stomach muscles tightening,” or “A thought ‘I can’t do this’ has come into my mind.”
- ☐ **Label what you observe.** Put a name on your feelings. Label a thought as just a thought, a feeling as just a feeling, an action as just an action.
- ☐ **Unglue your interpretations and opinions** from the facts. Describe the “who, what, when, and where” that you observe. Just the facts.
- ☐ Remember, **If you can’t observe it through your senses, you can’t describe it.**

PARTICIPATE

- ☐ **Throw yourself completely into activities of the current moment.** Do not separate yourself from what is going on in the moment (dancing, cleaning, talking to a friend, feeling happy or feeling sad).
- ☐ **Become one with whatever you are doing**, completely forgetting yourself. Throw your attention to the moment.
- ☐ **Act intuitively from Wise Mind.** Do just what is needed in each situation—a skillful dancer on the dance floor, one with the music and your partner, neither willful nor sitting on your hands.
- ☐ **Go with the flow.** Respond with spontaneity.

Mindfulness “What” Skills

Observe

- *Wordless watching*: Just notice the experience in the present moment.
- Observe both inside and outside yourself, using all of your five senses.
- Watch your thoughts and feelings come and go, as if they were on a conveyor belt.
- Have a “Teflon mind,” letting experiences come into your mind and slip right out (not holding on).
- Don’t push away your thoughts and feelings. Just let them happen, even when they’re painful.
- Note: we cannot observe another’s inner experience (“He’s upset.”)—only external features (e.g., a tear rolling down a cheek) or our thoughts about another’s experience (“I observed the thought ‘He’s upset.’”).

Describe

- Put words on the experience: Label what you observe with words.
- For example: “I feel sad,” “My face feels hot,” “I feel my heart racing,” “I’m having the thought that . . .,” “I’m having an urge to. . . .”
- Describe only what you observe *without* interpretations. Stick to the facts! Instead of “that person has an attitude,” you could describe that person as “rolling her eyes, speaking with a loud voice.”

Participate

- Throw yourself into the present moment fully (e.g., dancing, cleaning, taking a test, feeling sad in the moment). Try not to worry about tomorrow or focus on yesterday.
- Become one with whatever you’re doing: *Get into the zone*.
- Fully experience the moment without being self-conscious.
- Experience even negative emotions fully to help your Wise Mind make a decision about what to do (instead of acting impulsively).

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Ideas for Practicing Observing

BY COMING BACK TO YOUR SENSES

Remember: Observing is bringing your mind back to the sensations of your body and mind.

Observe with your eyes:

1. ☐ Lie on the ground and watch the clouds in the sky.
2. ☐ Walking slowly, stopping somewhere with a view, notice flowers, trees, and nature itself.
3. ☐ Sit outside. Watch who and what go by in front of you, without following them with your head or your eyes.
4. ☐ Notice the facial expression and movements of another person. Refrain from labeling the person's emotions, thoughts, or interests.
5. ☐ Notice just the eyes, lips, or hands of another person (or just one feature of an animal).
6. ☐ Pick up a leaf, a flower, or a pebble. Look at it closely, trying to see each detail.
7. ☐ Find something beautiful to look at, and spend a few minutes contemplating it.
8. Other: _____

Observe sounds:

9. ☐ Stop for a moment and just listen. Listen to the texture and shape of the sounds around you. Listen to the silences between the sounds.
10. ☐ If someone is talking, listen to the pitch of the voice, to the smoothness or roughness of the sounds, to the clarity or the mumbling of the speech, to the pauses between the words.
11. ☐ Listen to music, observing each note as it comes and the spaces between the notes. Try breathing the sounds into your body and letting them flow out again on your out breath.
12. Other: _____

Observe smells around you:

13. ☐ Breathing in, notice any smells around you. Bring something close to your nose, and notice the smells. Take it away, and then notice the smells again. Do they linger?
14. ☐ When eating, notice the aroma of the food; when cooking, notice the aroma of the spices or other ingredients; when bathing, smell the soap or shampoo; when walking outside, notice the aroma of the air; when near flowers, bend down and “smell the roses.”
15. Other: _____

Observe taste and the act of eating:

16. ☐ Putting something in your mouth, pay attention to the taste. Keep it in your mouth, and notice all the taste sensations.
17. ☐ Lick a lollipop or something else. Notice just the sensation of taste.
18. ☐ Eat a meal, or even a part of a meal, paying attention to the taste of each mouthful.
19. Other: _____

Observe urges to do something:

When you are feeling an urge to do something impulsive,

20. ☐ “Urge-surf” by imagining that your urges are a surfboard and you are standing on the board, riding the waves.
21. ☐ Notice any urge to avoid someone or something.
22. ☐ Scan your entire body, and notice the sensations. Where in the body is the urge?
23. ☐ When you are chewing your food, notice when you have the urge to swallow.
24. Other: _____

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MINDFULNESS HANDOUT 4A (p. 2 of 4)

Observe sensations of touch on your skin:

25. ☐ Stroke your upper lip with your fingernail.
 - Stop stroking, and notice how long it takes before you can't sense your upper lip at all.
26. ☐ When walking, notice the sensations of walking—your feet hitting the ground and rising up and down. Sometimes walk very slowly and notice. Sometimes walk very fast and notice.
27. ☐ When sitting, notice your thighs on the chair. Notice the curve of your knees and your back.
28. ☐ Pay attention to anything touching you.
 - Try to feel your feet in your shoes, your body touching your clothes.
 - Feel your arms touching a chair.
 - Notice the sensations of your hands.
29. ☐ Touch something—the wall, a fabric, a table top, a pet, a piece of fruit, a person.
 - Notice the texture of what you feel, notice the sensations on your skin.
 - Try it again with another part of your body.
 - Notice the sensations again.
30. ☐ Focus your attention on the sensations in your chest, your stomach, or your shoulders.
31. ☐ Focus your attention on the place in your body where you feel tight or tense.
32. ☐ Focus your attention on the space between your eyes.
33. Other: _____

Observe your breath: *Breathe evenly and gently, focusing your attention on:*

34. ☐ The movement of your stomach.
 - As you begin to breathe in, allow your belly to rise in order to bring air into the lower half of your lungs.
 - As the upper halves of your lungs begin to fill with air, your chest begins to rise.
 - As you breathe out, notice your belly, then notice your chest. Don't tire yourself.
35. ☐ The pauses in your breathing.
 - As you breathe in, notice the brief pause when your lungs have filled with air.
 - As you breathe out, notice the brief pause when you have expelled all the air.
36. ☐ The sensations in your nose as you breathe in and as you breathe out.
 - As you breathe, close your mouth and breathe in through your nose, noticing the sensations traveling up and down your nostrils.
37. ☐ Your breath while walking slowly. Breathe normally.
 - Determine the length of your breath—the exhalation and the inhalation—by the number of your footsteps. Continue for a few minutes.
 - Begin to lengthen your exhalation by one step. Do not force a longer inhalation. Let it be natural.
 - Watch your inhalation carefully to see whether there is a desire to lengthen it. Now lengthen the exhalation by one more footstep.
 - Watch to see whether the inhalation also lengthens by one step or not.
 - Only lengthen the inhalation when you feel that it will be comfortable.
 - After 20 breaths, return your breath to normal.
38. ☐ Your breath while listening to a piece of music.
 - Breathe long, light, and even breaths.
 - Follow your breath; be master of it, while remaining aware of the movement and sentiments of the music.
 - Do not get lost in the music, but continue to be master of your breath and yourself.
39. ☐ Your breath while listening to a friend's words and your own replies. Continue as with music.
40. Other: _____

(continued on next page)

MINDFULNESS HANDOUT 4A (p. 3 of 4)

Observe thoughts coming in and out of your mind:

41. ☐ Notice thoughts as they come into your mind.
 - Ask, "Where do thoughts come from?"
 - Then watch them to see if you can see where they come into your mind.
42. ☐ As you notice thoughts in your mind, notice the pauses between each thought.
43. ☐ Imagine that your mind is the sky and that thoughts are clouds.
 - Notice each thought-cloud as it drifts by, letting it drift in and out of your mind.
 - Imagine thoughts as leaves on water flowing down a stream, as boats drifting by on the lake, or as train cars rolling by you.
44. ☐ When worries go round and round in your mind, move your attention to the sensations in your body (those most intense right now). Then, keeping your attention on your body sensations, notice how long it takes for the worries to ooze away.
45. ☐ Step back from your mind, as if you are on top of a mountain and your mind is just a boulder down below.
 - Gaze at your mind, watching what thoughts come up when you are watching it.
 - Come back into your mind before you stop.
46. ☐ Watch for the first two thoughts that come into your mind.
47. Other: _____

Imagine that your mind is a:

48. ☐ Conveyor belt, and that thoughts and feelings are coming down the belt.
 - Put each thought or feeling in a box, and then put it on the conveyor belt and let it go by.
49. ☐ Conveyor belt, and that you are sorting thoughts and feelings as they come down the belt.
 - Label the types of thoughts or feelings coming by (e.g., worry thoughts, thoughts about my past, thoughts about my mother, planning-what-to-do thoughts, angry feeling, sad feelings).
 - Put them in boxes nearby for another time.
50. ☐ River, and that thoughts and feelings are boats going down the river.
 - Imagine sitting on the grass, watching the boats go by.
 - Describe or label each boat as it goes by.
 - Try not to jump on the boat.
51. ☐ Railroad track, and that thoughts and feelings are train cars going by.
 - Describe or label each as it goes by. Try not to jump on the train.
52. Other: _____

Observe by expanding awareness:

53. ☐ Breathing in, notice your breath. Then, keeping your breath in your awareness, on the next breath notice your hands. Then, keeping both in your awareness, on the next breath expand your awareness to sounds.
 - Continue holding all three in awareness at the same time.
 - Practice this awareness of threes at other times, selecting other things to be aware of.
54. ☐ Keeping your focus on what you are currently doing, gently expand your awareness to include the space around you.
55. ☐ Go hug a tree, and feel the sensations of the embrace.
 - Attend to the embrace of the sheets and blankets or comforters around you as you lie in bed.
 - Do this when you feel lonely and want to be loved or to love.
56. Other: _____

(continued on next page)

MINDFULNESS HANDOUT 4A (p. 4 of 4)

Open your mind to your senses:

57. ☐ Practice walking with your senses as wide open as you can make them.
- Notice what you hear, see, and feel.
 - Notice what you feel when shifting your weight between each step.
 - Notice your body experience as you turn.
58. ☐ For one mouthful in a meal, pause with a spoonful or forkful of food.
- Look at what you are going to eat, smell it, and listen to it. Then, when you are ready, put it in your mouth.
 - Note the taste, texture, temperature, and even the sound your teeth make in chewing your mouthful slowly.
 - Note the changes in its taste, texture, temperature, and sound as you chew it to completion.
59. ☐ Focus your mind on paying attention to each sensation that comes into your mind.
- Attend to sensations of sight, smell, touch, hearing, and taste, or to the thoughts generated by your brain.
 - Notice sensations as they arise, and notice them as they fall away.
 - Let your mind focus on each sensation as it arises.
 - Notice each sensation with curiosity, allowing it to be. Examine the uniqueness of each sensation.
60. ☐ Be here. Be in the present now.
- Take a moment to notice every sense you are aware of.
 - To yourself, make a statement, about each sense: “I feel the chair; the chair feels me.” “I hear the heater; the heater hears me.” “I see the wall; the wall sees me.” “I hear a stomach growl; it hears me.”
61. ☐ When a feeling arises within you, notice it—saying, for example, “A feeling of sadness is arising within me.”
62. ☐ When a thought arises within you, notice it—saying, for example, “The thought ‘It is hot in here’ is arising within me.”
63. ☐ Take just a moment of your time, and practice “nothing-to-do” mind.
- Let yourself become completely aware of your present experience, noticing sensations and the space around you.
64. ☐ Find a small object, one you can hold in your hand. Place it in front of you on a table or in your lap. Observe it closely—first not moving it, and then picking it up and turning it over and around, gazing at it from different angles and in different lights. Just notice shapes, colors, sizes, and other characteristics that are visible.
- Then change your focus to your fingers and hands touching the object. Notice the sensations of touching the object; notice the texture, temperature, and feel of the object.
 - Put the object down. Close your eyes, and inhale and exhale deeply and slowly.
 - Then, with beginner’s mind, open your eyes. With new vision, once again notice the object. With beginner’s mind, open to feeling new textures and sensations, explore the object with your fingers and hands.
 - Put down the object, and once again focus your mind on inhaling and exhaling once.
65. Other: _____

OBSERVING WITH YOUR SENSES

Here are some ideas to get you started observing using your senses, with room to add your own.

OBSERVE WITH YOUR EYES

Go for a walk in a park and observe the birds and nature.

Find an object in your room or backyard and observe the details.

Lay on the ground watching the clouds float by.

Set up a light projector and focus on the moving lights.

OBSERVE USING TASTE

Suck on a lollipop or hard candy and observe the flavours.
Bonus if it has layers!

Drink a cup of tea and observe the flavours and temperature

OBSERVE USING SOUND

Listen to music and observe each note and instrument.

Take a walk and listen to the sounds of nature.

Put on white noise, waves, or whale music.

OBSERVE USING SMELL

Light some candles and breathe in, noticing the scent.

Take a walk, focusing on the scents of nature.

As you cook a meal, focus on the smell of the ingredients.

ACCESSIBLE MINDFULNESS EXERCISES

It's really important to acknowledge and even celebrate the fact that everyone has a different brain and everyone responds to mindfulness differently.

Some individuals may find visualising and breathing-based mindfulness practices difficult or uncomfortable, which means certain mindfulness practices may not work for them. Some individuals may struggle to focus on internal sensations like breathing or body checks and that's okay too.

Remember, just because certain practices don't work for you doesn't mean you're doing it wrong - it just means it doesn't work for you and you need to find different techniques that do work for you. As you explore these practices, remember to be gentle and check in with yourself. Ask yourself how your body is responding. Ask yourself what feelings come up before, during or after these practices.

USE YOUR ENVIRONMENT

If you find yourself being pulled into your inner thoughts and sensations when using mindfulness, use your environment to ground yourself.

Focus on your surroundings by naming objects like the books on your shelf, the patterns in the rug, the number of tiles in the bathroom. If it helps, try naming the objects out loud or focusing on the details.

MINDFULLY LISTEN TO MUSIC

Tuning into ourselves and sitting in silence can be uncomfortable or even triggering for some people. Mindfully listening to music can be a way to direct your attention from your internal experience to something outside yourself like music.

Pay attention to what you're hearing; listen to the layers of the music, the complexities, the sounds of each instrument.

ACCESSIBLE MINDFULNESS EXERCISES

EXPLORE WITH PLAY-DOH, CLAY OR PLASTICINE

Explore the modelling material with your hands and notice the texture, the smell and the colour.

Experience it free from any expectation.

As you knead the material with your hands, focus on any changes and how those changes feel. Roll it into a ball or flatten it with your hand.

MINDFUL EATING

Pick a fruit which you can peel with your hands, like a banana, an orange, or my favourite - a mandarin. As you peel it, notice the texture and what the layer reveals underneath.

Notice the taste, texture, smell, colours and temperature with each bite.

MINDFUL STIMMING

Did you know that stimming can help us to focus and ground ourselves, as well as help us to regulate?

Sometimes, freeing the stim is the perfect way to create harmony and calm within us and bring us into the present moment. Try stim dancing or using some fidget items.

ACCESSIBLE MINDFULNESS EXERCISES

FIND A PERSONAL ANCHOR

Breathing is often a common anchor in mindfulness practices but when we can't trust or use our breathing, we can use a physical anchor like an object. Find an anchor that works for you; you might find that it's a personal object or a sensory object.

Sit with the anchor and explore it with whatever senses you prefer; use the anchor to practice mindfulness and ground yourself to the present moment.

HELPFUL PROMPTS

- What are your eyes or hands drawn to first?

- How does the object feel in your hand?
Focus on the weight of the object...

- Is the object stationary or is it moving around?

What does the surface of the object or item look like?
Focus on the texture... Shiny? Dull? Multi-textured?

- Does the surface have one colour or multiple colours?
Try looking at it in a different light or from a different angle...

- Does the object have round or sharp corners?

- Does the object have multiple surfaces?
Notice how they all connect...

- Can you feel the difference in the surfaces and textures?

- Is the object rigid or is it bendable?

- What do you notice that's unique about it?

MINDFULNESS WITH PETS

OBSERVE YOUR PET

Observe your pet and the way your pet looks at you or the way they make you feel. What do you notice about your pet?

Describe the way your pet looks by focusing on the texture of their fur, feathers or scales. Focus on the way their coat feels.

Participate by staying in the moment with your pet - perhaps talk to your pet or try cuddling them to stay present.

YOUR SENSES WITH YOUR PET

You probably do this already if you have a soft and cuddly friend, but when you're upset, you can hold them or cuddle them, use your senses to focus on the way they feel, the way they sound when they purr and the way they smell, especially if you bury your face in their fur.

...Maybe don't taste your pet ;)

ACTIVITIES WITH YOUR PET

Sometimes we might find it easier to be mindful while we're doing an activity; I know I do! You can do an activity or two with your pet/s!

Do an activity with your pet - washing them, grooming them or taking your pet for a walk. As you do so, focus on remaining present in the activity with your pet.

Ideas for Practicing Describing

Practice describing what you see outside of yourself:

1. ☐ Lie on the ground and watch the clouds in the sky. Find and describe cloud patterns that you see.
2. ☐ Sit on a bench on a busy street or at a park. Describe one thing about each person who walks by you.
3. ☐ Find things in nature—a leaf, a drop of water, a pet or other animal. Describe each thing in as much detail as you can.
4. ☐ Describe as accurately as you can what a person has just said to you. Check to see if you are correct.
5. ☐ Describe a person's face when the person seems angry, afraid, or sad. Notice and describe the shape, movement, and placement of the forehead, eyebrows, and eyes; the lips and mouth; the cheeks; and so on.
6. ☐ Describe what a person has done or is doing now. Be very specific. Avoid describing intentions or outcomes of the behavior that you do not directly observe. Avoid judgmental language.
7. Other: _____

Practice describing thoughts and feelings:

8. ☐ Describe your feelings as they arise within you: "A feeling of anger is arising within me."
9. ☐ Describe your thoughts when you feel a strong emotion: "I feel X, and my thoughts are Y."
10. ☐ Describe your feelings after someone else does or says something: "When you do X, I feel Y."
11. ☐ Describe thoughts, feelings, and what you observed others do: "When you do X, I feel Y, and my thoughts are Z." "When X occurs, I feel Y, and my thoughts are Z."
12. ☐ Describe as many of your thoughts as you can while feeling a strong emotion.
13. Other: _____

Practice describing your breathing:

14. ☐ Each time you inhale and exhale, as you inhale, be aware that "I am inhaling, 1." When you exhale, be aware that "I am exhaling, 1." Remember to breathe from the stomach. When beginning the second inhalation, be aware that "I am inhaling, 2." And, slowly exhaling, be aware that "I am exhaling, 2." Continue on up through 10. After you have reached 10, return to 1. Whenever you lose count, return to 1.
15. ☐ Begin to inhale gently and normally (from the stomach), describing in your mind that "I am inhaling normally." Exhale in awareness, "I am exhaling normally." Continue for three breaths. On the fourth breath, extend the inhalation, describing in your mind that "I am breathing in a long inhalation." Exhale in awareness, "I am breathing out a long exhalation." Continue for three breaths.
16. ☐ Follow the entrance and exit of air. Say to yourself, "I am inhaling and following the inhalation from its beginning to its end. I am exhaling and following the exhalation from its beginning to its end."
17. Other: _____

Ideas for Practicing Participating

Participate with awareness of connection to the universe:

1. ☐ Focus your attention on where your body touches an object (floor or ground, air molecules, a chair or armrest, your bed sheets and covers, your clothes, etc.). Try to see all the ways you are connected to and accepted by that object. Consider the function of that object with relation to you. That is, consider what the object does for you. Consider its kindness in doing that. Experience the sensation of touching the object, and focus your entire attention on that kindness until a sense of being connected or loved or cared for arises in your heart.

Examples: Focus your attention on your feet touching the ground. Consider the kindness of the ground holding you up, providing a path for you to get to other things, not letting you fall away from everything else. Focus your attention on your body touching the chair you sit in. Consider how the chair accepts you totally, holds you up, supports your back, and keeps you from falling down on the floor. Focus your attention on the sheets and covers on your bed. Consider the touch of the sheets and covers holding you, surrounding and keeping you warm and comfortable. Consider the walls in the room. They keep out the wind and the cold and the rain. Think of how the walls are connected to you via the floor and the air in the room. Experience your connection to the walls that provide you with a secure place to do things. Go hug a tree. Think of how you and the tree are connected. Life is in you and in the tree and both of you are warmed by the sun, held by the air and supported by the earth. Try and experience the tree loving you by providing something to lean on, or by shading you.

2. ☐ Dance to music.
3. ☐ Sing along with music you are listening to.
4. ☐ Sing in the shower.
5. ☐ Sing and dance while watching TV.
6. ☐ Jump out of bed and dance, or sing before getting dressed.
7. ☐ Go to a church that sings, and join in the singing.
8. ☐ Play karaoke with friends or at a karaoke club or bar.
9. ☐ Throw yourself into what another person is saying.
10. ☐ Go running, focusing only on running.
11. ☐ Play a sport and throw yourself into playing.
12. ☐ Become the count of the breath, becoming only “one” when you count 1, becoming only “two” when you count 2, and so on.
13. ☐ Become a word as you slowly say the word over and over and over.
14. ☐ Take a class in improvisational acting.
15. ☐ Take a dance class.
16. Other: _____



Taking Hold of Your Mind: “How” Skills

NONJUDGMENTALLY

- ☐ **See, but don’t evaluate as good or bad.** Just the facts.
- ☐ **Accept each moment like a blanket spread out on the lawn,** accepting both the rain and the sun and each leaf that falls upon it.
- ☐ **Acknowledge** the difference between the helpful and the harmful, the safe and the dangerous, **but don’t judge them.**
- ☐ **Acknowledge** your values, your wishes, your emotional reactions, **but don’t judge them.**
- ☐ When you find yourself judging, **don’t judge your judging.**

ONE-MINDFULLY

- ☐ **Rivet yourself to now.** Be completely present to this one moment.
- ☐ **Do one thing at a time.** Notice the desire to be half-present, to be somewhere else, to go somewhere else in your mind, to do something else, to multitask—and then come back to one thing at a time.
 - When you are eating, eat.
 - When you are walking, walk.
 - When you are worrying, worry.
 - When you are planning, plan.
 - When you are remembering, remember.
- ☐ **Let go of distractions.** If other actions, or other thoughts, or strong feelings distract you, go back to what you are doing—again, and again, and again.
- ☐ **Concentrate your mind.** If you find you are doing two things at once, stop—go back to one thing at a time (the opposite of multitasking!).

EFFECTIVELY

- ☐ **Be mindful of your goals in the situation,** and do what is necessary to achieve them.
- ☐ **Focus on what works.** (Don’t let emotion mind get in the way of being effective.)
- ☐ **Play by the rules.**
- ☐ **Act as skillfully as you can.** Do what is needed for the situation you are in—not the situation you wish you were in; not the one that is fair; not the one that is more comfortable.
- ☐ **Let go of willfulness and sitting on your hands.**

Mindfulness “How” Skills

Don’t Judge

- Notice but don’t evaluate as good or bad. Stick to the observable facts of the situation, using only what is observed with your senses.
- Acknowledge the harmful and the helpful, but don’t judge it. For example, replace “He’s a jerk” with “He walked away while we were talking.”
- You can’t go through life without making judgments; your goal is to catch and replace them with descriptions so you have more control over your emotions.
- When you find yourself judging, *don’t judge your judging*.

Stay Focused

- One-mindfully: Focus your attention on *only* one thing in this moment. Slow yourself down to accomplish this.
- Stop doing two things at once (the opposite of multitasking).
- Concentrate your mind: Let go of distractions and refocus your attention when it drifts, again and again.
- Stay focused so that past, future, and current distractions don’t get in your way.

Do What Works

- Be effective: Focus on what works to achieve your goal.
- Don’t let emotions control your behavior; cut the cord between feeling and doing.
- Play by the rules (which may vary at home, school, work).
- Act as skillfully as you can to achieve your goals.
- Let go of negative feelings (e.g., vengeance and useless anger) and “shoulds” (e.g., “My teacher should have. . .”) that can hurt you and make things worse.

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Ideas for Practicing Nonjudgmentalness

Leaving out comparisons, judgments, and assumptions:

1. ☐ Practice observing judgmental thoughts and statements, saying in your mind, **“A judgmental thought arose in my mind.”**
2. ☐ **Count judgmental thoughts and statements** (by moving objects or pieces of paper from one pocket to another, by clicking a sports counter, or by marking a piece of paper).
3. ☐ Replace judgmental thoughts and statements with nonjudgmental thoughts and statements.

Tips for replacing judgment by stating the facts:

1. **Describe the facts** of the event or situation—*only* what is observed with your senses.
 2. **Describe the consequences** of the event. Keep to the facts.
 3. **Describe your own feelings** in response to the facts (remember, emotions are not judgments).
4. ☐ **Observe your judgmental facial expressions, postures, and voice tones** (including voice tones in your head).
 5. ☐ **Change judgmental expressions, postures, and voice tones.**
 6. ☐ Tell someone what you did today nonjudgmentally, or about an event that occurred. Stay very concrete; only relate what you observed directly.
 7. ☐ **Write out a nonjudgmental description** of an event that prompted an emotion.
 8. ☐ Write out a nonjudgmental blow-by-blow account of a particularly important episode in your day. Describe both what happened in your environment and what your thoughts, feelings, and actions were. Leave out any analysis of why something happened, or why you thought, felt, or acted as you did. Stick to the facts that you observed.
 9. ☐ Imagine a person you are angry with. Bring to mind what the person has done that has caused so much anger. Try to become that person, seeing life from that person’s point of view. Imagine that person’s feelings, thoughts, fears, hopes, and wishes. Imagine that person’s history and what has happened in his or her history. Imagine understanding that person.
 10. ☐ When judgmental, **practice half-smiling and/or willing hands.** (See Distress Tolerance Handout 14: Half-Smiling and Willing Hands.)
 11. Other: _____

Ideas for Practicing One-Mindfulness

1. ☐ **Awareness while making tea or coffee.** Prepare a pot of tea or coffee to serve a guest or to drink by yourself. Do each movement slowly, in awareness. Do not let one detail of your movements go by without being aware of it. Know that your hand lifts the pot by its handle. Know that you are pouring the fragrant, warm tea or coffee into the cup. Follow each step in awareness. Breathe gently and more deeply than usual. Take hold of your breath if your mind strays.
2. ☐ **Awareness while washing the dishes.** Wash the dishes consciously, as though each bowl is an object of contemplation. Consider each bowl sacred. Follow your breath to prevent your mind from straying. Do not try to hurry to get the job over with. Consider washing the dishes the most important thing in life.
3. ☐ **Awareness while hand-washing clothes.** Do not wash too many clothes at one time. Select only three or four articles of clothing. Find the most comfortable position to sit or stand, so as to prevent a backache. Scrub the clothes consciously. Hold your attention on every movement of your hands and arms. Pay attention to the soap and water. When you have finished scrubbing and rinsing, your mind and body will feel as clean and fresh as your clothes. Remember to maintain a half-smile and take hold of your breath whenever your mind wanders.
4. ☐ **Awareness while cleaning house.** Divide your work into stages: straightening things and putting away books, scrubbing the toilet, scrubbing the bathroom, sweeping the floors, and dusting. Allow a good length of time for each task. Move slowly, three times more slowly than usual. Focus your attention fully on each task. For example, while placing a book on the shelf, look at the book; be aware of what book it is; know that you are in the process of placing it on the shelf; and know that you intend to put it in that specific place. Know that your hand reaches for the book and picks it up. Avoid any abrupt or harsh movement. Maintain awareness of the breath, especially when your thoughts wander.
5. ☐ **Awareness while taking a slow-motion bath.** Allow yourself 30–45 minutes to take a bath. Don't hurry for even a second. From the moment you prepare the bath water to the moment you put on clean clothes, let every motion be light and slow. Be attentive of every movement. Place your attention on every part of your body, without discrimination or fear. Be aware of each stream of water on your body. By the time you've finished, your mind will feel as peaceful and light as your body. Follow your breath. Think of yourself as being in a clean and fragrant lotus pond in the summer.
6. ☐ **Awareness with meditation.** Sit comfortably on the floor with your back straight, on the floor or in a chair with both feet touching the floor. Close your eyes all the way, or open them slightly and gaze at something near. With each breath, say to yourself, quietly and gently, the word "One." As you inhale, say the word "One." As you exhale, say the word "One," calmly and slowly. Try to collect your whole mind and put it into this one word. When your mind strays, return gently to saying "One." If you start wanting to move, try not to move. Just gently observe wanting to move. Continue practicing a little past wanting to stop. Just gently observe wanting to stop.
7. Other: _____

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Ideas for Practicing Effectiveness

1. ☐ Observe when you begin to get angry or hostile with someone. Ask yourself, “Is this effective?”
2. ☐ Observe yourself when you start wanting to be “right” instead of effective. Give up being “right” and switch to trying to be effective.
3. ☐ Notice willfulness in yourself. Ask yourself, “Is this effective?”
4. ☐ Drop willfulness, and practice acting effectively instead. Notice the difference.
5. ☐ When feeling angry or hostile or like you're about to do something ineffective, practice willing hands.
6. Other: _____

SELF CHECK-IN

Checking in with ourselves is probably the most helpful thing we can do every day. When we do this, we can figure out what our needs are in the moment and use that information to respond to our needs and take care of ourselves.

You can use this skill to check in with your basic needs like making sure you've had some water or eaten food. You can also use this skill to determine whether you need a sensory break or support.

You can use the prompts below to guide your self check-in.

WHAT EMOTIONS AM I FEELING RIGHT NOW?
WHAT ARE THESE FEELINGS TRYING TO TELL ME?
HOW IS MY BODY REACTING?
WHAT AM I THINKING RIGHT NOW?

HOW IS MY MOOD?

- how am I feeling?
- are my emotions fleeting or long lasting?

HOW IS MY ENERGY?

- am I tired, energetic or average?
- do I need to eat something or rest?

HOW IS MY BREATHING?

- am I breathing fast or slow?
- am I exhaling from my stomach or chest?

HOW IS MY FOCUS?

- am I able to concentrate or am I distracted?
- am I able to focus for a long or short time?

HOW IS MY BODY DOING?

- do I have any tension or pain?
- do I need to rest my body?

Mindfulness Cheat Sheet

1. Identify what you will focus on:

Examples: Your breath

An object (a picture, burning candle)

An activity (brushing your hair, cleaning your room, reading)

2. Bring your attention to the object of focus.

3. When your attention wanders away from the object of focus (and sometimes it will, so don't judge yourself for it!) . . .

- Notice that this has happened.
- Gently bring your attention back to the object of focus.



To Get Started

Begin practicing mindfulness by noticing your attention and how it wanders. Gradually work on doing this practice for 30 seconds, 1 minute and 2 minutes at a time. Practice *a lot*. No one will know you are doing it!

Your attention may wander to noises around you, worry thoughts, judgmental thoughts such as “this is stupid,” body sensations, urges to talk, and so on). Notice them, let them go, and return your attention to the object of focus.

.....

*Handouts for Other Perspectives
on Mindfulness Skills*

.....

Overview:
Other Perspectives on Mindfulness

MINDFULNESS PRACTICE:

A Spiritual Perspective

SKILLFUL MEANS:

**Taking hold of your everyday life by
balancing Doing Mind and Being Mind**

WISE MIND:

Walking the Middle Path

Goals of Mindfulness Practice: A Spiritual Perspective

TO EXPERIENCE:

- ☐ Ultimate reality *as it is* which leads to a sense of inner spaciousness and awareness of intimate wholeness with the entire universe, the transcendence of boundaries, and the ground of our being.
- ☐ Other: _____

TO GROW IN WISDOM:

- ☐ Of the heart and of action.
- ☐ Other: _____

TO EXPERIENCE FREEDOM:

- ☐ By letting go of attachments to the demands of your own desires, cravings, and intense emotions, and radically accepting reality as it is.
- ☐ Other: _____

TO INCREASE LOVE AND COMPASSION:

- ☐ Toward yourself.
 - ☐ Toward others.
 - ☐ Other: _____
-
- ☐ Other: _____

Wise Mind from a Spiritual Perspective

Wise Mind as . . . Contemplative practice Mindfulness Meditation Contemplative prayer Contemplative action Centering prayer	Thoughts, attitudes, and actions designed to help us express or experience connection to: • The sacred, the divine within, the transcendent. • God, the Great Spirit, the Absolute, Elohim, the nameless one, Brahma, Allah, Parvardigar. • Ultimate reality, the totality, the source, our essential nature, our true self, the core of our being, the ground of being. • No self, emptiness.
Wise Mind experience from a spiritual perspective	Experience where a deeper layer of reality rises to consciousness. A reality that has always been there but has been misperceived. An experience of expansion of consciousness; the experience of unity and oneness within the sacred.
Wise Mind from the perspective of mysticism (seven characteristics of mystical experiences)	1. Direct experience: Experience without words of <i>ultimate reality</i>. 2. Experience of unity: Awareness of oneness and of no distance between oneself, reality, and all other beings. 3. Without words: Experience of reality that cannot be grasped and can only be described with metaphors and stories. 4. Certain: During the experience, certainty of the experience is total, undeniable, clear. 5. Practical: Experience that is concretely beneficial to one's life and well-being. 6. Integrative: Experience that establishes harmony of love, compassion, mercy, kindness; quieting of extreme emotions. 7. Sapiential: Experience that leads to wisdom, enhances capacity for intuitive knowledge.

Practicing Loving Kindness to Increase Love and Compassion

WHAT IS LOVING KINDNESS?

Loving kindness is a mindfulness practice designed to increase love and compassion first for ourselves and then for our loved ones, for friends, for those we are angry with, for difficult people, for enemies, and then for all beings.

Loving kindness can protect us from developing and holding on to judgmentalness, ill will, and hostile feelings toward ourselves and others.

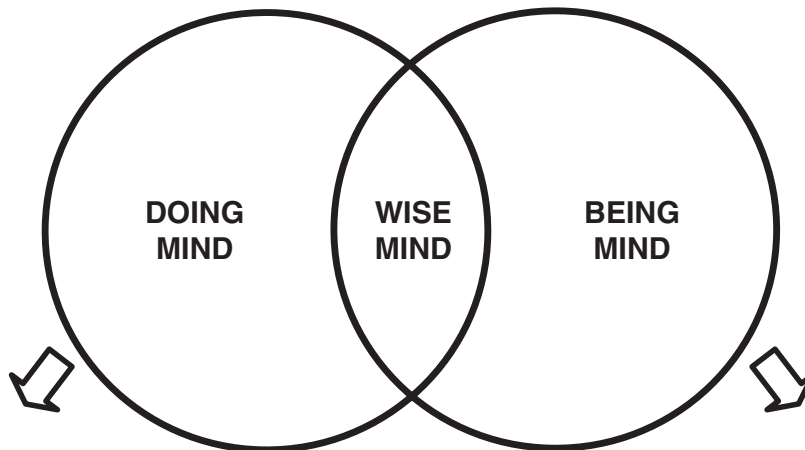
PRACTICING LOVING KINDNESS

Practicing loving kindness is like saying a prayer for yourself or someone else. As when you are asking or praying for something for yourself or others, you actively send loving and kind wishes, and recite in your mind words and phrases that express good will toward yourself and others.

LOVING KINDNESS INSTRUCTIONS

1. Choose a person to send loving kindness toward. Do *not* select a person you do not want to relate to with kindness and compassion. Start with yourself, or, if this is too difficult, with a person you already love.
2. Sitting, standing, or lying down, begin by breathing slowly and deeply. Opening the palms of your hands, gently bring the person to mind.
3. Radiate loving kindness by reciting a set of warm wishes, such as “May I be happy,” “May I be at peace,” “May I be healthy,” “May I be safe,” or another set of positive wishes of your own. Repeat the script slowly, and focus on the meaning of each word as you say it in your mind. (If you have distracting thoughts, just notice them as they come and go and gently bring your mind back to your script.) Continue until you feel yourself immersed in loving kindness.
4. Gradually work yourself up through loved ones, friends, those you are angry with, difficult people, enemies, and finally all beings. For example, use a script such as “May John be happy,” “May John be at peace,” and so on (or “John, may you be happy,” “May you be at peace,” and so on), as you concentrate on radiating loving kindness to John.
5. Practice each day, starting with yourself and then moving to others.

Skillful Means: Balancing Doing Mind and Being Mind



Doing Mind Is:

- Discriminating Mind
- Ambitious Mind
- Goal-Oriented

When in *doing mind*, you view your thoughts as facts about the world. You are focused on problem solving and achieving goals.

Being Mind Is:

- Curious Mind
- Nothing-to-Do Mind
- Present-Oriented

When in *being mind*, you view your thoughts as sensations of the mind. You are focused on the uniqueness of each moment, letting go of focusing on goals.

Wise Mind Is:

- A balance of doing and being
- The middle path

When in Wise Mind, you:

Use skillful means.

Let go of having to achieve goals—and throw your entire self into working toward these same goals.

Enhance awareness while engaging in activities.

Note. The terms “doing mind,” “being mind,” and “nothing-to-do mind” were first used by Jon Kabat-Zinn in *Full Catastrophe Living* (1990, 2013).

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Ideas for Practicing Balancing Doing Mind and Being Mind

The mindfulness skills require a lot of practice. The practice ideas below are to help you act skillfully in everyday life, bringing together doing activities of everyday life with being mind.

1. ☐ **Wise Mind reading.** To increase your desire for mindfulness, find readings or quotations that have the effect of making you actually want to practice mindfulness in your everyday life. Put these quotations at strategic spots in your life (e.g., near the coffee maker), and then while you are waiting for other things, read the inspirational messages.

2. ☐ **Wise Mind reminders.** Set an alarm at home, at work, or (if possible) on your cell phone or watch to go off randomly or at set times. Use the alarm as a reminder to be mindful of your current activities. (See www.mindfulnessdc.org/bell/index.html or a similar Internet site for a free mindfulness clock to download onto your computer.) Set up automatic text messages or Twitter messages to remind yourself. Write out mindfulness quotations that you like, and tape them in strategic places where you will see them as reminders to practice mindfulness.

3. ☐ **Wise Mind in the routine of daily life.** Choose one routine activity in your daily life (such as brushing your teeth, getting dressed, making coffee or tea, working on a task). Make a deliberate effort to bring moment-to-moment awareness to that activity.

4. ☐ **“Just this one moment” Wise Mind.** When you begin to feel overwhelmed or frazzled, say, “Just this one moment, just this one task,” to remind yourself that your only requirement at the moment is to do one thing in the moment—wash one dish, take one step, move one set of muscles. In this moment, let the next moment go until you get there.

(continued on next page)

Note. Exercises 3 and 4 are from Segal, Z. V., Williams, J. M. G., & Teasdale, J. D. (2013). *Mindfulness-based cognitive therapy for depression: A new approach to preventing relapse* (2nd ed.). New York: Guilford Press. Copyright 2013 by The Guilford Press. Adapted by permission. All other exercises are adapted from Kabat-Zinn, J. (1990). *Full catastrophe living: Using the wisdom of your body and mind to face stress, pain, and illness*. New York: Delacorte Press. Copyright 1990 by Jon Kabat-Zinn. Adapted by permission of Random House.

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5. ☐ **Wise Mind awareness of events.** Notice events in your everyday life (both pleasant and unpleasant), even if they are only very small (such as warm water on your hands when washing, the taste of something you eat, the feel of wind on your face, the fact that your car is running out of gas or that you are tired).

6. ☐ **Wise Mind awareness of what needs to be done.** When relaxing after a hard day's work or at a break during the day, stay aware of what needs to be done and focus on doing what is needed.

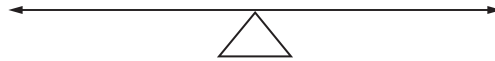
7. ☐ **Wise Mind willingness.** Practice willingness to do what is needed when you are asked, or when you see that something needs to be done. Do what is needed with a balance of being and doing, focusing the mind, immersing yourself in the task.

8. ☐ **Three-minute WISE MIND: Slowing down “doing mind” in your everyday life**
 - Bring yourself into the present moment by adopting a “wide-awake” posture, and then, in Wise Mind, ask, “What is my experience right now? What thoughts and images are going through my mind?” Notice them as mental events, as neural firing in your brain. Next ask, “What are my feelings and sensations in my body?” Notice these as they come into your awareness. Then say, “OK, this is how it is right now.”
 - Settle into Wise Mind and focus your entire attention on your breath as it goes in and as it goes out, one breath after another. Gather yourself all together, and focus on the movements of your chest and abdomen, the rise and fall of your breath, moment by moment, breath by breath as best you can. Let your breath become an anchor to bring you into the present moment.
 - Once you have gathered yourself to some extent, allow your awareness to expand. As well as being aware of the breath, include also a sense of the body as a whole, your posture, your facial expression, your hands. Follow the breath as if your whole body is breathing. When you are ready, step back into your activities, acting from Wise Mind of your whole body in the present moment.

9. ☐ **Other Wise Mind practice ideas:** _____

Walking the Middle Path: Finding the Synthesis between Opposites

**Reasonable
mind**



**Emotion
mind**

Both regulate actions and make decisions based on reason,
And
take into account values and experience even strong emotions as they come and go.

**Doing
mind**



**Nothing-to-do
mind**

Both do what is needed in the moment (including reviewing the past or planning for the future),
And
experience fully the uniqueness of each moment in the moment.

**Intense desire
for change
of the moment**



**Radical
acceptance
of the moment**

Both allow yourself to have an intense desire to have something else than what is now,
And
be willing to radically accept what you have in your life in the present moment.

Self-denial



Self-indulgence

Both practice moderation,
And
satisfy the senses.

Other:



MINDFULNESS SUMMARY

What mindfulness practices are most helpful for you?

What are some signs that you need to use these skills?

Can you identify any barriers or accommodations needed in using these skills?

What reminders do you need to use these mindfulness tools?

.....

Mindfulness Worksheets

*Worksheets for Core
Mindfulness Skills*

.....

Pros and Cons of Practicing Mindfulness

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Make a list of the pros and cons of practicing mindfulness skills.

Make another list of the pros and cons of *not* practicing mindfulness skills.

Check the facts to be sure that you are correct in your assessment of advantages and disadvantages.

Rate Willingness to Practice (0 = None; 100 = Very High) **Before:** _____ **After:** _____

Fill this worksheet out when you are:

- Trying to decide whether to work on becoming more mindful of the moments in your life.
- Feeling willful; saying no to letting go of emotion mind or extreme reasonable mind.
- Resisting observing the present moment, rather than escaping it or trying to control it.
- Resisting giving up your interpretations of others or yourself, rather than just describing.
- Resisting throwing yourself into the flow of the moment; wanting to stand on the outside.
- Feeling threatened whenever you think of letting go of judgments.
- Not in the mood for being effective instead of proving you are right.

When you are filling out this worksheet, think about these questions:

- Is a mindless life in your best interest (i.e., effective), or not in your best interest (i.e., ineffective)?
- Will refusing to go into Wise Mind solve a problem, or make a new problem for you?
- Is observing the moment without reacting to it immediately likely to increase your freedom, or decrease it?
- Is being attached to your thoughts instead of the facts you can describe useful, or not?
- Is staying judgmental helping you change the things you want to change, or getting in the way?
- Is it more important to be effective, or to be right?

PROS	Stay Mindless, Judgmental, Ineffective	Practice Mindfulness
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
CONS	Stay Mindless, Judgmental, Ineffective	Practice Mindfulness
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
	_____	_____

What did you decide to do? _____**Is this the best decision (in Wise Mind)?** _____**List any and all wise things you did this week.** _____

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Mindfulness Core Skills Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Describe the situations that prompted you to practice mindfulness.

SITUATION 1

Situation (who, what, when, where):

- ☐ Wise Mind
- ☐ Observe
- ☐ Describe
- ☐ Participate
- ☐ Nonjudgmentally
- ☐ One-mindfully
- ☐ Effectively

At left, check the skills you used, and describe your use of them here.

Describe experience of using the skill:

Check if practicing this mindfulness skill has influenced any of the following, *even a little bit*:

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ Reduced suffering | ☐ Increased happiness | ☐ Increased ability to focus |
| ☐ Decreased reactivity | ☐ Increased wisdom | ☐ Increased experiencing the |
| ☐ Increased connection | ☐ Increased sense of personal validity | present |

SITUATION 2

Situation (who, what, when, where):

- ☐ Wise Mind
- ☐ Observe
- ☐ Describe
- ☐ Participate
- ☐ Nonjudgmentally
- ☐ One-mindfully
- ☐ Effectively

At left, check the skills you used, and describe your use of them here.

Describe experience of using the skill:

Check if practicing this mindfulness skill has influenced any of the following, *even a little bit*:

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ Reduced suffering | ☐ Increased happiness | ☐ Increased ability to focus |
| ☐ Decreased reactivity | ☐ Increased wisdom | ☐ Increased experiencing the |
| ☐ Increased connection | ☐ Increased sense of personal validity | present |

List any and all wise things you did this week. _____

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Mindfulness Core Skills Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

For each mindfulness skill, write down what you did during the week, and then rate the quality of mindfulness you experienced during your practice.

*I could not focus my mind
for even 1 second; I was
completely mindless and quit.*

1

2

*I was able to focus my
mind somewhat and stay
in the present moment.*

3

4

*I became centered in Wise
Mind and was free to let go
and do what was needed.*

5

Day

Wise Mind

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:

Observe

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:

Describe

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:

Participate

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:

Nonjudgmentally

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:

One-mindfully

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:

Effectively

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

List any and all wise things you did this week. _____

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 2B (Mindfulness Handouts 2–5c)

Mindfulness Core Skills Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Practice each mindfulness skill twice, and describe your experience as follows:

When did you practice this skill, and what did you do to practice?	What was going on that prompted practicing mindfulness (if anything)?	How much time passed when you were doing this skill?	Rate before/after skill use		Conclusions or questions about this skills practice
			Degree of focusing my mind (0–100)	Degree of being centered in Wise Mind (0–100)	
Wise Mind:			/	/	
			/	/	
Observe:			/	/	
			/	/	
Describe:			/	/	
			/	/	
Participate:			/	/	
			/	/	
Nonjudgmentally:			/	/	
			/	/	
One-mindfully:			/	/	
			/	/	
Effectively:			/	/	
			/	/	

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Note. Adapted from an unpublished worksheet by Seth Axelrod, with his permission.

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 2C

(Mindfulness Handouts 2–5c) (p. 1 of 2)

Mindfulness Core Skills Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off skills to practice this week:

____ Wise Mind ____ Observing ____ Describing ____ Participating ____ Nonjudgmentally ____ One-mindfully ____ Effectively

While you are practicing skills, stay as aware and mindful as you can. Write it down later.

Name(s) of skill(s)	How did you practice the skill?	Describe your experience, including body sensations, emotions, and thoughts while practicing the skill	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Example: <i>Participating</i>	<i>I went to a party and joined in conversations with other people.</i>	<i>I felt a tight knot in my stomach, shallow breathing, dry mouth, anxiety that other people would not like me; later I enjoyed the conversation, smiled, noticed other people around me, and ended up having a good time.</i>	<i>I feel amazed that I managed to do this and felt good about myself. I am thinking I may be able to do this again.</i>
Monday:			
Tuesday:			
Wednesday:			

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 2C

(p. 2 of 2)

Name(s) of skill(s)	How did you practice the skill?	Describe your experience, including body sensations, emotions, and thoughts while practicing the skill	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Thursday:			
Friday:			
Saturday:			
Sunday:			

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Wise Mind Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Wise Mind Practice Exercise: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 1. Attended to my breath coming in and out, letting my attention settle into my center.
- ☐☐☐☐ 2. Imagined being a flake of stone on the lake.
- ☐☐☐☐ 3. Imagined walking down an inner spiral stairs.
- ☐☐☐☐ 4. Dropped into the pauses between inhaling and exhaling.
- ☐☐☐☐ 5. Breathed “wise” in, “mind” out.
- ☐☐☐☐ 6. Asked Wise Mind a question (breathing in) and listened for the answer (breathing out).
- ☐☐☐☐ 7. Asked myself, “Is this Wise Mind?”
- ☐☐☐☐ 8. Other (describe): _____
- ☐☐☐☐ 9. Other (describe): _____

Describe the situation and how you practiced Wise Mind:

How effective was the practice in helping you become centered in your Wise Mind?

*Not effective:
I couldn't do the skill
for even 1 minute. I got
distracted or quit.*

1

2

*Somewhat effective:
I was able to practice Wise Mind
and became somewhat centered
in my Wise Mind.*

3

4

*Very effective:
I became centered in Wise
Mind, and was free to do
what needed to be done.*

5

Describe the situation and how you practiced Wise Mind:

How effective was the practice in helping you become centered in your Wise Mind?

*Not effective:
I couldn't do the skill
for even 1 minute. I got
distracted or quit.*

1

2

*Somewhat effective:
I was able to practice Wise Mind
and became somewhat centered
in my Wise Mind.*

3

4

*Very effective:
I became centered in Wise
Mind, and was free to do
what needed to be done.*

5

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Mindfulness “What” Skills: Observing, Describing, Participating

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off the mindfulness skills you practiced this week. Write out descriptions of two different times when you practiced a mindfulness skill. Use back of sheet for more examples.

____ Observing ____ Describing ____ Participating

Describe the situation and how you practiced the skill:

Check if practicing this mindfulness skill has improved any of the following, *even a little bit*:

____ Reduced suffering ____ Increased happiness ____ Increased ability to focus
____ Decreased reactivity ____ Increased wisdom ____ Increased experiencing the present
____ Increased connection ____ Increased sense of personal validity

Describe how the skill helped or did not help you become more mindful: _____

Describe the situation and how you practiced the skill:

Check if practicing this mindfulness skill has improved any of the following, *even a little bit*:

____ Reduced suffering ____ Increased happiness ____ Increased ability to focus
____ Decreased reactivity ____ Increased wisdom ____ Increased experiencing the present
____ Increased connection ____ Increased sense of personal validity

Describe how the skill helped or did not help you become more mindful: _____

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

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Observing, Describing, Participating Checklist

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off mindfulness skills that you use when you use them. You can check each skill up to four times. If you practice a skill more than four times, extend your checks toward the edge of the page, or use the back of the page if needed.

Practice observing: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 1. What you see: _____ Watch without following what you see.
- ☐☐☐☐ 2. Sounds: _____ Sounds around you, _____ pitch and sound of someone's voice, _____ music.
- ☐☐☐☐ 3. Smells around you: _____ Aroma of food, _____ soap, _____ air as you walk.
- ☐☐☐☐ 4. The taste of what you eat and the act of eating.
- ☐☐☐☐ 5. Urges to do something: _____ Urge-surf, _____ notice urge to avoid, _____ notice where in body urge is.
- ☐☐☐☐ 6. Body sensations: _____ Body scan, _____ sensation of walking, _____ body touching something.
- ☐☐☐☐ 7. Thoughts coming in and out of your mind: _____ Imagine your mind as a river, _____ as a conveyor belt.
- ☐☐☐☐ 8. Your breath: _____ Movement of stomach, _____ sensations of air in and out nose.
- ☐☐☐☐ 9. By expanding awareness: _____ To your entire body, _____ to space around you, _____ to hugging a tree.
- ☐☐☐☐ 10. By opening the mind: _____ To each sensation arising, not attaching, letting go of each.
- ☐☐☐☐ 11. Other (describe): _____

Practice describing: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 12. What you see outside of your body.
- ☐☐☐☐ 13. Thoughts, feelings, and body sensations inside yourself.
- ☐☐☐☐ 14. Your breathing.
- ☐☐☐☐ 15. Other (describe): _____

Practice participating: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 16. Dance to music.
- ☐☐☐☐ 17. Sing along with music you are listening to.
- ☐☐☐☐ 18. Sing in the shower.
- ☐☐☐☐ 19. Sing and dance while watching TV.
- ☐☐☐☐ 20. Jump out of bed and dance or sing before getting dressed.
- ☐☐☐☐ 21. Go to a church that sings and join in the singing.
- ☐☐☐☐ 22. Play karaoke with friends or at a karaoke club or bar.
- ☐☐☐☐ 23. Throw yourself into what another person is saying.
- ☐☐☐☐ 24. Go running, riding, skating, walking; become one with the activity.
- ☐☐☐☐ 25. Play a sport and throw yourself into playing.
- ☐☐☐☐ 26. Become the count of your breath, becoming only “one” when you count 1, becoming only “two” when you count 2, and so on.
- ☐☐☐☐ 27. Become a word as you slowly say the word over and over and over.
- ☐☐☐☐ 28. Throw caution to the wind, and throw yourself into a social or work activity.
- ☐☐☐☐ 29. Other (describe): _____

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 4B (Mindfulness Handouts 4–4c)

Observing, Describing, Participating Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off at least two skills to practice this week: ____ Observing ____ Describing ____ Participating

While you are practicing skills, stay as aware and mindful as you can. Write it down later.

Name(s) of skill(s)	How did you practice the skill?	Describe your experience, including body sensations, emotions, and thoughts while practicing the skill	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Example: Observing	<i>I took a walk in the park and observed the trees I encountered.</i>	<i>I felt calm, my shoulders relaxed. I felt curiosity toward the trees I was observing, a sense of detachment from my own worries; I thought the leaves of the trees were very green and refreshing.</i>	<i>I feel somewhat relaxed; I think I should go for walks more often. I am anxious that next time I might not be able to pay attention to the practice.</i>
Monday:			
Tuesday:			
Wednesday:			

(continued on next page)

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 4B

(p. 2 of 2)

Name(s) of skill(s)	How did you practice the skill?	Describe your experience, including body sensations, emotions, and thoughts while practicing the skill	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Thursday:			
Friday:			
Saturday:			
Sunday:			

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Mindfulness “How” Skills: Nonjudgmentalness, One-Mindfulness, Effectiveness

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off the mindfulness skills you practiced this week. Write out descriptions of two different times when you practiced a mindfulness skill. Use back of sheet for more examples.

___ Nonjudgmentalness ___ One-mindfulness ___ Effectiveness

Describe the situation and how you practiced the skill:

Check if practicing this mindfulness skill has improved any of the following, *even a little bit*:

___ Reduced suffering ___ Increased happiness ___ Increased ability to focus
___ Decreased reactivity ___ Increased wisdom ___ Increased experiencing the present
___ Increased connection ___ Increased sense of personal validity

Describe how the skill helped or did not help you become more mindful: _____

Describe the situation and how you practiced the skill:

Check if practicing this mindfulness skill has improved any of the following, *even a little bit*:

___ Reduced suffering ___ Increased happiness ___ Increased ability to focus
___ Decreased reactivity ___ Increased wisdom ___ Increased experiencing the present
___ Increased connection ___ Increased sense of personal validity

Describe how the skill helped or did not help you become more mindful: _____

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

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Nonjudgmentalness, One-Mindfulness, Effectiveness Checklist

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Practice nonjudgmentalness: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 1. Say in your mind, “A judgmental thought arose in my mind.”
- ☐☐☐☐ 2. Count judgmental thoughts.
- ☐☐☐☐ 3. Replace judgmental thoughts and statements with nonjudgmental thoughts and statements.
- ☐☐☐☐ 4. Observe your judgmental facial expressions, postures, voice tones.
- ☐☐☐☐ 5. Change judgmental expressions, postures, voice tones.
- ☐☐☐☐ 6. Stay very concrete and describe your day nonjudgmentally.
- ☐☐☐☐ 7. Write out a nonjudgmental description of an event that prompted an emotion.
- ☐☐☐☐ 8. Write out a nonjudgmental blow-by-blow account of a particularly important episode in your day.
- ☐☐☐☐ 9. Imagine a person you are angry with. Imagine understanding that person.
- ☐☐☐☐ 10. When you feel judgmental, practice half-smiling and/or willing hands.

Describe the situation and how you practiced nonjudgmentalness:

Practice one-mindfulness: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 11. Awareness while making tea or coffee.
- ☐☐☐☐ 12. Awareness while washing the dishes.
- ☐☐☐☐ 13. Awareness while hand-washing clothes.
- ☐☐☐☐ 14. Awareness while cleaning house.
- ☐☐☐☐ 15. Awareness while taking a slow-motion bath.
- ☐☐☐☐ 16. Awareness with meditation.

Describe the situation and how you practiced one-mindfulness:

Practice effectiveness: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 17. Give up being right
- ☐☐☐☐ 18. Drop willfulness
- ☐☐☐☐ 19. Doing what is effective

Describe the situation and how you practiced effectiveness:

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 5B (Mindfulness Handouts 5–5c)

Nonjudgmentalness, One-Mindfulness, Effectiveness Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off at least two skills to practice this week: ____ Nonjudgmentally ____ One-mindfully ____ Effectively

While you are practicing skills, stay as aware and mindful as you can. Write it down later.

Name(s) of skill(s)	How did you practice the skill?	Describe your experience, including body sensations, emotions, and thoughts while practicing the skill	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Example: <i>One-mindfully</i>	<i>I dusted my house and focused only on that task while doing it.</i>	<i>I experienced the softness of the cloth on my hands; I felt content I was able to do something useful; I started to think about all the other cleaning I needed to do afterward, but I brought my focus back to just doing the dusting.</i>	<i>I remember it felt good my husband noticed I cleaned up the house; I feel content I did my practice; I think I could have practiced better if my mind had drifted away less.</i>
Monday:			
Tuesday:			
Wednesday:			

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 5B

(p. 2 of 2)

Name(s) of skill(s)	How did you practice the skill?	Describe your experience, including body sensations, emotions, and thoughts while practicing the skill	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Thursday:			
Friday:			
Saturday:			
Sunday:			

91 List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 5C

(Mindfulness Handouts 5–5c)

Nonjudgmentalness Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Be aware of nonjudgmental thoughts and expressions when they happen. Use the following questions to focus your awareness on the details of the experience as it is happening. Write it down later.

Did you practice observing judgmental thoughts?	Did you count judgmental thoughts? If so, how many?	If you replaced a judgmental thought or assumption, what was the judgmental thought or assumption?	What was the replacement thought or assumption?	If you replaced judgmental with nonjudgmental facial or other physical expressions, please describe.	Describe any change after practicing.
Example: Yes	21	<i>My boyfriend is such a jerk because he should have remembered to pick me up.</i>	<i>He did forget to pick me up! I wish he had not forgotten to pick me up.</i>	<i>I half-smiled and unclenched my fists.</i>	
Monday:					
Tuesday:					
Wednesday:					

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 5C

(p. 2 of 2)

Did you practice observing judgmental thoughts?	Did you count judgmental thoughts? If so, how many?	If you replaced a judgmental thought or assumption, what was the judgmental thought or assumption?	What was the replacement thought or assumption?	If you replaced judgmental with nonjudgmental facial or other physical expressions, please describe.	Describe any change after practicing.
Thursday:					
Friday:					
Saturday:					
Sunday:					

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

.....

*Worksheets for Other Perspectives
on Mindfulness Skills*

.....

Loving Kindness

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off the types of loving kindness mindfulness practices you did this week. Write out descriptions of two different times when you practiced loving kindness. Use the back of this worksheet if more space is needed.

____ To myself ____ To a loved one ____ To a friend ____ To someone I was angry with
____ To a difficult person ____ To an enemy ____ To all beings ____ Other: _____

Describe the script you used (i.e., the warm wishes you sent):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Check if practicing loving kindness has increased any of the following, *even a little bit* toward this person: ____ Feelings of warmth or caring ____ Love ____ Compassion
____ Feelings of connection ____ Wisdom ____ Happiness ____ Sense of personal validity

Describe how the skill helped or did not help you become more compassionate: _____

____ To myself ____ To a loved one ____ To a friend ____ To someone I was angry with
____ To a difficult person ____ To an enemy ____ To all beings ____ Other: _____

Describe the script you used (i.e., the warm wishes you sent): ____ Same as above (check if correct).

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Check if practicing loving kindness has increased any of the following, *even a little bit* toward this person: ____ Feelings of warmth or caring ____ Love ____ Compassion
____ Feelings of connection ____ Wisdom ____ Happiness ____ Sense of personal validity

Describe how the skill helped or did not help you become more compassionate: _____

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

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Balancing Being Mind with Doing Mind

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Everyday Wise Mind practice: Check off Wise Mind practice exercises each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 1. Wrote out and then read an inspirational writing on mindfulness.
- ☐☐☐☐ 2. Set Wise Mind reminders to remind me to practice mindfulness.
- ☐☐☐☐ 3. Put written reminders to practice mindfulness in strategic places.
- ☐☐☐☐ 4. Made a deliberate effort to bring moment-to-moment awareness to an everyday activity.
- ☐☐☐☐ 5. Focused on just “this one moment” when I was overwhelmed, frazzled, or scattered.
- ☐☐☐☐ 6. Focused awareness on events in my everyday life.
- ☐☐☐☐ 7. Focused awareness on what needs to be done in my everyday life.
- ☐☐☐☐ 8. Acted willingly and did what was needed.
- ☐☐☐☐ 9. Did 3-minute Wise Mind to slow down “doing mind” in my everyday life.
- ☐☐☐☐ 10. Other (describe): _____

Describe one or more situations where you balanced being with doing mind:

How effective was the practice in helping you find Wise Mind in your everyday life?

*Not effective:
I couldn't do the skill
for even 1 minute. I got
distracted or quit.*

1

2

*Somewhat effective:
I was able to practice Wise
Mind and became somewhat
centered in my Wise Mind.*

3

4

*Very effective:
I became centered in Wise
Mind, and was free to do
what needed to be done.*

5

Describe one or more situations where you balanced being with doing mind:

How effective was the practice in helping you find Wise Mind in your everyday life?

*Not effective:
I couldn't do the skill
for even 1 minute. I got
distracted or quit.*

1

2

*Somewhat effective:
I was able to practice Wise
Mind and became somewhat
centered in my Wise Mind.*

3

4

*Very effective:
I became centered in Wise
Mind, and was free to do
what needed to be done.*

5

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 7A

(Mindfulness Handouts 9, 9a)

Mindfulness of Being and Doing Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Be aware of a moment when you feel frazzled, overwhelmed, or scattered at the time it is happening. Pay attention to your experience at that time. Try to bring your focus back to “just this one moment,” not the next moment and not the past moment. Use the following questions to focus your awareness on the details of the experience as it is happening. Write it down later.

What was the experience?	What was the one activity in just one moment that you could bring your attention to?	How did your body feel doing one thing at a time?	Describe your experience of practicing the skill.	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Example: <i>Feeling overwhelmed at the number of dishes I had to wash before going to bed.</i>	<i>Washing just one dish.</i>	<i>Arms relaxed, hands felt warm and sudsy, back relaxed.</i>	<i>Relief, “Oh, only one dish,” tension flowing out.</i>	<i>This was not so hard, but what about next time? I’ll have to practice this.</i>
Monday:				
Tuesday:				
Wednesday:				

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 7A (p. 2 of 2)

What was the experience?	What was the one activity in just one moment that you could bring your attention to?	How did your body feel doing one thing at a time?	Describe your experience of practicing the skill.	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Thursday:				
Friday:				
Saturday:				
Sunday:				

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 8 (Mindfulness Handouts 9, 9a)

Mindfulness of Pleasant Events Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Be aware of a pleasant event at the time it is happening. Pay attention to everyday, ordinary events that at the time feel pleasant to you. Try to experience the moment, even if it is only fleeting. Use the following questions to focus your awareness on the details of the experience as it is happening. Write it down later.

What was the experience?	What was the one activity in just one moment that you could bring your attention to?	How did your body feel during this experience?	Describe your emotions and thoughts while practicing the skill.	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Example: <i>Seeing a bird while walking around green lake.</i>	<i>Yes.</i>	<i>Lightness across the face, aware of shoulders dropping, uplift of corners of mouth.</i>	<i>Relief, pleasure, "That's good," "How lovely (the bird) sings," "It's so nice to be outside."</i>	<i>It was such a small thing but I'm glad I noticed it.</i>
Monday:				
Tuesday:				
Wednesday:				

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 8 (p. 2 of 2)

What was the experience?	What was the one activity in just one moment that you could bring your attention to?	How did your body feel during this experience?	Describe your emotions and thoughts while practicing the skill.	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Thursday:				
Friday:				
Saturday:				
Sunday:				

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 9 (Mindfulness Handouts 9, 9a)

Mindfulness of Unpleasant Events Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Be aware of an unpleasant event at the time it is happening. Pay attention to everyday, ordinary events that at the time feel painful or unpleasant to you. Try to experience the moment, even if it is only fleeting. Use the following questions to focus your awareness on the details of the experience as it is happening. Write it down later.

What was the experience?	Were you aware of the unpleasant feelings <i>while</i> the event was happening?	How did your body feel during this experience?	Describe your emotions and thoughts while practicing the skill.	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Example: My boyfriend forgot my birthday.	Yes.	<i>Tears just behind my eyes, sinking feeling in stomach, drooping of face and shoulders, tired.</i>	<i>Hurt, sadness, "He doesn't care enough to remember me," "Does he really love me?" Wanting to go to sleep until tomorrow.</i>	<i>He is a pretty forgetful guy. Maybe I need to remind him a lot.</i>
Monday:				
Tuesday:				
Wednesday:				

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 9

(p. 2 of 2)

What was the experience?	Were you aware of the unpleasant feelings <i>while</i> the event was happening?	How did your body feel during this experience?	Describe your emotions and thoughts while practicing the skill.	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Thursday:				
Friday:				
Saturday:				
Sunday:				

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Walking the Middle Path to Wise Mind

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

WALKING THE MIDDLE PATH: Check off WISE MIND practice exercises each time you do one.

Worked at **balancing**:

- ☐☐☐☐ 1. Reasonable mind with emotion mind to get to Wise Mind.
- ☐☐☐☐ 2. Doing mind with being mind to get to Wise Mind.
- ☐☐☐☐ 3. Desire for change of the present moment with radical acceptance to get to Wise Mind.
- ☐☐☐☐ 4. Self-denial with self-indulgence to get to Wise Mind.
- ☐☐☐☐ 5. Other: _____

WALKING THE MIDDLE PATH: Describe one or more situations where you walked the middle path, and tell how you did this:

How effective was the practice in helping you walk the middle path?

*Not effective:
I couldn't do the skill
for even 1 minute. I got
distracted or quit.*

1

2

*Somewhat effective:
I was able to practice Wise Mind
and became somewhat centered
in my Wise Mind.*

3

4

*Very effective:
I became centered in Wise
Mind, and was free to do
what needed to be done.*

5

WALKING THE MIDDLE PATH: Describe one or more situations where you walked the middle path, and tell how you did this:

How effective was the practice in helping you walk the middle path?

*Not effective:
I couldn't do the skill
for even 1 minute. I got
distracted or quit.*

1

2

*Somewhat effective:
I was able to practice Wise Mind
and became somewhat centered
in my Wise Mind.*

3

4

*Very effective:
I became centered in Wise
Mind, and was free to do
what needed to be done.*

5

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Analyzing Yourself on the Middle Path

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

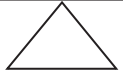
1. **Figure out where you are off the middle path, toward one extreme or the other.** For each of the following Wise Mind dilemmas, put an X on the line that represents where you think you are most of the time. If you are fairly balanced, put the X in the middle. If you are out of balance, put the X near the end that you are too extreme on.

Reasonable mind	←—————△————→	Emotion mind
Doing mind	←—————△————→	Nothing-to-do mind
Intense desire for change of the moment	←—————△————→	Radical acceptance of what is
Self-denial	←—————△————→	Self-indulgence

2. **Choose one dilemma.** Describe *very specifically* what you are doing that is too much, and then describe what you do too little of.

Too much _____ _____ _____		Too little _____ _____ _____
---	--	---

3. **Check the facts.** Check for interpretations and opinions. Make sure that your list of activities you do too much of or too little of is in fact accurate. Check your own values in Wise Mind: Be sure to work on your middle path, not someone else's. Also check for **judgments**. Avoid "good," "bad," and judgmental language. Rewrite any items above if needed so that they are **factual and nonjudgmental**.
4. **Decide** on one (or at most two) *very specific* things to do in the next week to get closer to balance.

Do less _____ _____ _____		Do more _____ _____ _____
--	---	--

5. **Describe** what you did since last week: _____
6. **Rate** how effective the practice was in helping you become more balanced on the middle path. Rate it from 1 (did not help at all) to 5 (very effective, really helped): _____

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

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Walking the Middle Path Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Day	Describe the tension between the:		Describe in detail how you managed the tension between the pulls of the two sides.
	Pull to one side	Pull to opposite side	
Example: <i>Doing projects around the house</i>	<i>Desperately working on lots of projects to renovate my house.</i>	<i>Watching TV, eating ice cream, leaving projects needed to sell house undone</i>	<i>I decided to do one small project each day and one medium project each week to improve the house. I also decided to have at least 1 hour each day of not thinking or worrying about the house, and instead doing something pleasant for myself.</i>
Monday:			
Tuesday:			
Wednesday:			

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 10B

(p. 2 of 2)

Day	Describe the tension between the:		Describe in detail how you managed the tension between the pulls of the two sides.
	Pull to one side	Pull to opposite side	
Thursday:			
Friday:			
Saturday:			
Sunday:			

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____